

CHAPTER

31



Shvitra

Learning Objectives

- ⇒ To know the concept of Shvitra
- ⇒ To enlist the types of Shvitra
- ⇒ To know about the Lakshana and Sadhyasadyata of Shvitra

Introduction

*Shvitra*¹ is a spectrum of diseases where in whitish discolouration of the skin is observed in the affected individuals. This is said to be manifested in the individuals due to the vitiation of all three *Dosha* in most of the occasions.

In other words, there is a possibility of vitiation of one *Dosha* or two *Dosha* during the pathogenesis and progression of the disease.

The site of the affliction of the disease is *Tvak*. The affliction of *Dushya* in this condition are *Rasa*, *Rakta* (primary *Dhatu* afflicted), *Mamsa* and *Ambu* (similar to *Kushtha*). *Srotas* afflicted in the disease are *Raktavaha Srotas* (primary *Srotas*), *Rasavaha Srotas*, *Mamsavaha Srotas* and *Udakavaha Srotas*.

Type of *Srotodushti* involved in the disease are *Sanga* and *Vimargagamana*. As far as *Sadhyasadyata* of the disease is concerned, this is considered as *Asadhyata* (incurable) in nature.

दारुणं चारुणं श्वित्रं किलासं नामभिस्त्रिभिः।

विज्ञेयं त्रिविधं तच्चै त्रिदोषं प्रायशब्ध तत्॥ 73 ॥

Ca.Ci. - 7/173

Shvitra is caused by the vitiation of all three *Dosha* in most of the occasions. Sometimes, either single *Dosha* or dual *Dosha* vitiation may produce the manifestation of *Shvitra*. It is classified into 3: *Daruna*, *Charuna* and *Shvitra*. This is also being termed as *Kilasa*.



Figure 121: Image of Shvitra

Clinical features of Shvitra

दोषे रक्ताश्रिते रक्तं तानं मांससमाश्रिते।

श्वेतं मेदः श्रिते श्वित्रं गुरु तच्चोत्तरोत्तरम्॥ 74 ॥

Ca.Ci. - 7/174

- ⊕ If the vitiated *Dosha* reside in *Rakta Dhatu* and may exhibit the patches in skin that is red in colour. This is called as *Daruna* variety of *Shvitra*.
- ⊕ If the vitiated *Dosha* reside in *Mamsa Dhatu*, then the colour of the skin may turn coppery. This is called as *Charuna* variety of *Shvitra*.
- ⊕ If the vitiated *Dosha* reside in *Medo Dhatu*, then the

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- 1 This disease can be attributable to albinism where melanin pigment is absent in the human body. Melanin is the pigment which gives colour to the skin, hair and eyes. These people are more prone to sunburn and carcinoma of the skin and its appendages.
 - This disease can affect people of all races and all ethnic groups.
 - This disease is not contagious and will not spread to normal individuals from the suffering individuals. This disease is genetically transferrable.

colour of the skin may appear white. This is called as *Shvitra* proper.

- As far as severity of the *Shvitra* is concerned, the *Shvitra* appearing in *Rakta Dhatu* is of milder form; the *Shvitra* appearing in *Mamsa Dhatu* is of moderate form and the *Shvitra* observed in *Medo Dhatu* is considered as severe form of the disease.

Sadhyasadyata of Shvitra

यत् परस्परतोऽभिन्नं बहु यद्रतलोमयत्।
यच्च वर्षगणोत्पन्नं तच्छिन्नं नैव सिध्यति॥ 75॥
अरक्तलोम तनु यत् पाण्डु नातिचिरोत्थितम्।
मध्यावकारो चोच्छन्नं श्वित्रं तत्साध्यमुच्यते॥ 76॥

Ca.Ci. – 7/175-176

- If the patches² in the skin are mutually attached or matted together, if there are multiple lesions surrounded by red hairs for longer duration are said to be *Asadya*.
- If the patches in the skin are surrounded by other than reddish hairs, having white and thin patches which have recently manifested, that possess elevated margins between two patches are said to be *Sadya*.

Self-Assessment: Questions for Review

Long essay questions

- Explain *Shvitra* in detail
- Describe *Shvitra* with current understanding

Short essay questions

- Describe *Shvitra* in brief
- Describe the types of *Shvitra*

MCQs

1. Kilasa is the synonym of

- a. *Shvitra*;
- b. *Visarpa*;
- c. *Kushtha*;
- d. *Kamala*

Answer: (a)

2. As per Charaka, Sankhya Samprapti of Kilasa is

- a. 1;
- b. 2;
- c. 3;
- d. 4

Answer: (c)

3. Coppery discolouration of Shvitra is seen in which of the following type of Shvitra?

- a. *Daruna*;
- b. *Charuna*;
- c. *Shvitra*;
- d. All of the above

Answer: (b)

4. Which of the following is responsible for dark complexion of the body?

- a. Sweat glands;
- b. Melanin;
- c. Keratin;
- d. Androgen

Answer: (b)

5. Daruna, Charuna and Shvitra are the types of

- a. *Visarpa*;
- b. *Kushtha*;
- c. *Ajirna*;
- d. *Kilasa*

Answer: (d)

Chapter resources

- Charaka Samhita Chikitsa Sthana – *Kushtha Chikitsa Adhyaya*
- Madhava Nidana 49th chapter – *Kushtha Nidana Adhyaya*
- Golwalla's medicine for students by Aspi F Golwalla and Sharukh A Golwalla, edited by Milind Y Nadkar, 25th edition, Jaypee Brothers Medical Publishers (P) Ltd, New Delhi, 2017
- The Merck Manual of Diagnosis and Therapy by Robert S Porter and Justin L Kaplan, 19th edition, Merck Sharp & Dohme Corp, New Jersey, 2011
- Chamberlain's symptoms and signs in clinical medicine by Colin Ogilvie and Christopher C Evans, 12th edition, Butterworth-Heinemann Publishers, 1997
- Best & Taylor's physiological basis of medical practice by O P Tandon and Y Tripathi, 13th edition, Wolters Kluwer Health (India) Pvt. Ltd, Gurgaon, 2012
- Textbook of Medical physiology by Arthur C Guyton and John E Hall, 11th edition, Saunders Elsevier publications, Philadelphia, 2006
- www.healthline.com
- Shvitra* is a spectrum of diseases where in whitish discolouration of the skin is observed in the affected individuals. All three Dosha are said to be responsible for the manifestation of the disease. It is also being said that either one Dosha or dual Dosha vitiation may also be responsible for the manifestation of the disease. *Tvak* is afflicted in the disease. *Rasavaha*, *Raktavaha*, *Mamsavaha* and *Udakavaha Srotas* are afflicted in the disease with *Sanga* and *Vimargagamana* as the type of *Srotodushti* involved during the progression of the disease.
- It is also called as *Kilasa*. 3 types of *Shvitra* (*Kilasa*) are mentioned. *Daruna*, *Charuna* and *Shvitra* are the types mentioned in *Charaka Samhita* where reddish, coppery and whitish patches observed in the skin respectively.
- Diffuse patches of *Shvitra* are incurable whereas small, discrete patches are considerably easily manageable.

- 2 As far as surface area of the skin is concerned, it has the surface area of 1.5 to 2 sqm (16-22 sqft) in an average adult human being and it is second largest organ of the human body, the first being the inside of the small intestine which is 15 to 20 times larger than the skin surface. This implies larger area of the skin is involved. This is easily noticeable by the people surrounding the suffering people. Whereas smaller patches may be unnoticeable by the surrounding people.